

The Lead Track

This will be the song's main melody, so let's rename it in the mixer by clicking on the track name and calling it Main.

By default, the track type is Instrument—leave it that way. Click under Instrument to bring up a list of instruments you can choose from, and select the instrument. To start playing the song, click on the Compose button.



Choosing the track type and instrument

Composing the Lead Track

The Composer, by default, is a piano keyboard which you can play by either using the mouse to click on the keys or by using your PC's keyboard. You will also find a bar with musical notation, which will make little or no sense if you haven't formally studied music. Thankfully, Anvil Studio's really handy help panel contains instructions to help you out.



The Composer

If you find the piano keyboard uncomfortable to work with, you can select "Piano Roll" from the drop-down menu at the top left.

Creating the melody is going to involve a lot of experimentation, and can end up as a long and frustrating exercise, but it will be worth it when you finally have your own composition ready!

Drums and Rhythms

Now that you've created a melody, it's time to add a rhythm track for the background. Go to Track > Create > Rhythm Track to create a new track.